

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- ✓ Complete Answer Key
- ✓ Full Lesson Plan
- ✓ Common Student Mistakes
- ✓ Teacher Tip
- ✓ Extra Class Activity
- ✓ Extension & Exit Ticket

WORKSHEET INFORMATION

LEVEL	A1
SKILL	Practice (Grammar + Reading + Writing)
TOPIC	Subordinating conjunctions: if, before, after, while, because, when
EXERCISES	6 (A–F)
EST. TIME	45–50 minutes
ANSWER KEY	Included above

ANSWER KEY

A. Match the Conjunctions to Their Use

- | | |
|------------------------------------|---|
| 1. if → a condition or possibility | 4. while → two actions at the same time |
| 2. before → something earlier | 5. because → a reason |
| 3. after → something later | 6. when → a time |

B. Complete with the Correct Conjunction

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|
| 1. When / After you finish your homework, you can watch TV. | 4. after / when (it stopped raining) |
| 2. before (I go to bed) | 5. While (I cook dinner) |
| 3. because (I got good grades) | 6. when (you get to the airport) |

Items 1 and 4 accept two answers – mark any conjunction that fits the meaning.

C. Read the Text and Answer

- | | |
|--|---------------------------------------|
| 1. They left early in the morning, before the sun got too hot. | 4. Because they were all very hungry. |
| 2. They listened to their favourite songs. | 5. They will go (camping) again. |
| 3. They went hiking (and enjoyed the view). | |

D. Combine the Sentences

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. I went to bed early because I was tired. | 4. After she finished her class, she went to the library. |
| 2. We waited at the bus stop when the bus arrived. (also: When the bus arrived, we were waiting at the bus stop.) | 5. He watched TV while he exercised. |
| 3. If you study hard, you will pass the test. | 6. I locked the door before I left the house. |

E. Put the Words in Order

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|---|
| 1. I will call you when I arrive. | 4. She reads a book while she waits. |
| 2. We have dinner after we get home. | 5. I wash my hands before I eat. |
| 3. If it is cold, wear a jacket. | 6. He was late because he missed the bus. |

F. Write Your Own Sentences

Personal answers – one sentence per conjunction (if, before, after, while, because, when). Check the two parts of the sentence make sense together and the conjunction joins them (comma if the conjunction starts the sentence).

TEACHING SUPPORT

TEACHER TIP

The 'Conjunctions at a Glance' box gives one meaning and one model sentence for each word – that is the whole lesson. Have students keep a finger on it during Exercises A and B and read the model aloud before choosing.

COMMON STUDENT MISTAKES

- ✗ I stayed home, I was sick.
- ✓ I stayed home because I was sick.
- ✗ Before I will eat, I wash my hands.
- ✓ Before I eat, I wash my hands.
- ✗ I will call you when I will arrive.
- ✓ I will call you when I arrive.
- ✗ She reads a book, she waits.
- ✓ She reads a book while she waits.

EXTRA CLASS ACTIVITY

Two Halves (8 min)

Write six sentence halves on the board (e.g. 'I was happy...', '...because I passed the test'). Students match them and say which conjunction joins each pair, then write two new half-sentences for a partner to finish with a conjunction.

LEARNING FOCUS

Objective: Students will be able to choose and use if, before, after, while, because and when to join two ideas into one sentence, in speaking and writing.

Success Criteria: I can say what each conjunction is for (time, reason, condition). I can join two sentences into one with the right conjunction, and add a comma when it starts the sentence.

Prior Knowledge: Simple present and past sentences; basic time and daily-activity vocabulary.

LESSON PLAN (45–50 MINUTES)

Level: A1

Skill: Practice (Grammar + Reading + Writing)

Topic: Subordinating conjunctions: if, before, after, while, because, when

Exercises: 6 (A–F)

Est. Time: 45–50 minutes

MATERIALS & PREP

- Printed worksheet copies (1 per student)
- Board for the 6 conjunctions and their uses

- Pens or pencils

TIME	STAGE	PROCEDURE
5 min	Warm-Up	Say two short sentences: 'I was tired.' 'I went to bed.' Ask the class: how can we make one sentence? Elicit 'because' or 'so'. Write 'I went to bed because I was tired.' and circle 'because'.
12 min	Presentation (I Do)	Board the six conjunctions in three groups: TIME – before (earlier), after (later), while (same time), when (a point in time); REASON – because; CONDITION – if. One two-clause model each: 'Brush your teeth <u>before</u> you go to bed.' / 'I read <u>while</u> I wait.' / 'I stayed home <u>because</u> I was sick.' / 'If it rains, we will stay home.' Comma rule: conjunction at the front → comma between the parts; in the middle → no comma. Model Exercise D item 1: 'I was tired.' + 'I went to bed early.' + (because) → 'I went to bed early because I was tired.'
12 min	Guided Practice (We Do)	Exercise A together (1-to-1 match, using the board groups). Then Exercise B items 1–3 as a class: read the sentence, decide the meaning (time / reason / condition), choose the conjunction, note where more than one works.
10 min	Independent Practice (You Do)	Students complete Exercise C (read + answer), Exercise D (combine) and Exercise E (order the words) alone; compare D in pairs, checking commas.
6 min	Assessment	Review Exercise D on the board: students read the joined sentence and say which conjunction and whether a comma is needed. Students complete the Exit Ticket individually.
5 min	Closure	Students write two of their Exercise F sentences and read one to a partner, who names the conjunction and its use.

FOLLOW-UP / HOMEWORK IDEA

Homework: write a short paragraph (5 sentences) about last weekend, using at least four different conjunctions from the box.

ANTICIPATED PROBLEMS & SOLUTIONS

Problem: Students use a future verb after 'if' and 'when' ('I will call you when I will arrive').

Solution: Rule on the board: after if / when for the future, use the present simple – only the main clause has 'will'.

Problem: Students confuse before / after (which action is first).

Solution: Draw a timeline, put both actions on it and read 'A before B' / 'B after A' left to right.

FOR EXTRA SUPPORT

Give weaker students the three-group board (TIME / REASON / CONDITION) as a desk card; they label the relationship before choosing the conjunction.

FOR AN EXTRA CHALLENGE

Students rewrite three Exercise E sentences, moving the conjunction to the front and adding the comma.

LANGUAGE FOCUS & BOARD NOTES

Grammar: subordinating conjunctions if / before / after / while / because / when; present simple after if/when for the future; comma after a fronted clause.

Board: I stayed home because I was sick. • Before you go to bed, brush your teeth. • If it rains, we will stay home.

EXIT TICKET — QUICK CHECK

- Choose: I was late ____ I missed the bus. → *because*
- Join: 'It is cold.' + 'Wear a jacket.' (if) → *If it is cold, wear a jacket.*
- Fix: I will call you when I will arrive. → *I will call you when I arrive.*

TEACHER REFLECTION:

☐ What worked well? ☐ What didn't work? ☐ Who needed extra support? ☐ What will I change next time?